



Jailbreaking bug fixed

Apple fixed a bug that allowed users to jailbreak their iPhones yet again.
<https://digit.in/sep19-70>



AT&T CEO to retire

John Donovan, AT&T's CEO announced his plans to retire in October.
<https://digit.in/sep19-71>

Audio Technica ATH-S200BT

Undercuts the competition

Audio Technica is slowly but surely starting to establish itself as a worthwhile contender in the consumer audio space. Their latest consumer headphones offering, the Audio Technica ATH-S200BT headphones are priced conservatively at ₹4,490 and these pair of wireless headphones are one of the best options in the category they comfortably reside in. Let's delve further into exploring these cans as we put them to test.

Build Quality

The ATH-S200BT headphones sport sleek black and grey accents but the body is largely made out of plastic which causes them to feel pretty flimsy in-hand. However, the headphones don't creak and the buttons don't rattle, so the build is pretty decent.

The comfort, for us, was certainly a downside. The pads on the earcups use basic reflex foam instead of memory foam, which makes them significantly less comfortable to wear. The headphones also don't fold up, which is a shame.

The clamping force of the headphones is too tight for our taste. However, the tight fit makes them very secure and minimises sound leakage as well.

Features

While the headphones lacks flashy, premium features such as water resistance, there are a few good features onboard. The cans have a superb battery life which lasts upto 40 hours. Most headphones at this price, or even higher come nowhere close to this.

Wireless reliability is excellent as well. We suffered absolutely no glitches during the pairing process. The headphones feature Bluetooth 4.1 and offer a listening range of about 33 feet. During our tests, we experienced minimal lags



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or jumps even when we were a considerable distance away. The playback controls all reside on the bottom of the left earcup. The ATH-S200BT headphones also house a Bluetooth notification light, physical volume and pause/play buttons. The pause/play button also doubles up as a call button. The micro-USB charging slot also resides here. While we'd prefer a USB Type-C port, that may be a bit too much to ask at this price point.

Performance

The sound quality is actually quite good on these affordable Bluetooth headphones. They cover the basics pretty well and sound quite solid throughout an array of genres. They are tonally competent, the bass isn't overpowering or underwhelming, the treble is not overly sharp or muted and the mids aren't too held back either. However, the headphones are dynamically flat, in the sense that they can struggle to bring music to life unless the volume is turned up considerably.

In *Pull Me Under* by *Dream Theatre*, the headphones are unable to appropriately

separate the vocals and the instruments. *Paradise City* by *Guns 'n Roses* seems listless overall unless the volume is set at above 80 per cent.

On the other hand, vocals are abundantly clear on these headphones when not masked by an array of instruments, and there is almost no noticeable distortion, even in intensive tracks like *Centuries* by *Fall Out Boy*. These cans can get exceedingly loud and generally seem to be more suited towards warmer tracks.

Media playback on Netflix and YouTube was quite an enjoyable experience and the headphones properly emulated the dialogue and background sounds. Call quality is somewhat touch and go on these headphones. The voice coming through seems to be hollow and far-away, however, the person on the other end could hear what we were saying quite clearly.

Verdict

The Audio Technica ATH-S200BT headphones sport incredible battery life, great wireless connectivity and good overall sound, which is more than what we'd expect at this price point. While they may have some issues such as non-folding design, clamp being too tight, and less than ideal sound dynamics, they do have plenty of redeeming qualities. You'll actually be hard-pressed to find a pair of Bluetooth headphones that cough up the battery life and sound quality the ATH-S200BT deliver. If you're on a budget, these pair of headphones may just be the ideal pair for you.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

DRIVERS: 40mm | IMPEDANCE: 32 ohms | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 5 - 32,000 Hz | BLUETOOTH VERSION 4.1 | BATTERY LIFE: Approx. 40 hours | CHARGING TIME: Approx. 4 hours | WEIGHT: 190 g

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